

SAI PREETHI POKA

United States | pokasaipreethi@gmail.com | [LinkedIn](#) | [GitHub](#) | [Portfolio](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data Scientist with experience in forecasting, A/B testing, causal inference, and ML pipeline development. Experienced in building scalable solutions using Python, R, PySpark, SQL, and cloud tools like AWS & Airflow. Passionate about turning data into products that drive decisions.

EXPERIENCE

Graduate Student Assistant

California State University

May 2024 – May 2025

Long Beach, US

- Verified student records and cross-checked exam rosters with database entries to ensure accuracy and compliance.
- Created summary tables and visual aids in Excel to highlight trends and support curriculum assessments.
- Analyzed student performance data for accreditation reports; identified patterns and gaps for faculty review.

Data Scientist – Retail Analytics

Harman International (Client: Circana, formerly IRI)

Aug 2021 – Jul 2023

Bangalore, IN

- Built ML classification models to detect brand reversals during COVID-19 using POS/syndicated data, improving client engagement tracking by 20%.
- Migrated market structure workflows to PySpark and Python, reducing data processing time by 30%.
- Improved forecasting application by troubleshooting anomalies and supporting production runs across 10+ regions.
- Developed a trend-based forecasting module in R, reducing model runtime costs by 25% and enabling faster reforecasts.
- Streamlined RGM reporting to include Australia, cutting turnaround time by 40% and improving cross-market visibility.
- Generated custom reports and provided analytical support during the annual execution of the Hispanic Insights Advantage program, ensuring timely and accurate delivery to client teams.

Product Analyst Intern

Cognizant Technology Solutions

Feb 2021 – Jun 2021

Hyderabad, IN

- Aligned KPIs and dashboards with business goals by gathering cross-functional requirements.
- Redesigned SQL schemas, improving data accessibility and cutting query time by 25%+.
- Verified API accuracy and response time using Postman, ensuring analytics reliability.
- Integrated backend sources to improve dashboard data flow, reducing load times by 20%.

PROJECTS

Air Quality Forecasting & Analytics | [GitHub](#)

- Developed a time-series forecasting pipeline for AQI data using Prophet and Python, applying supervised learning techniques, and automating deployment with Streamlit and Git for version control.
- Enabled real-time monitoring through a dashboard, improving interpretability of forecasts for non-technical users.

A/B Testing Automation & ML Analysis | [GitHub](#)

- Developed an automated A/B testing pipeline with XGBoost, achieving 96.8% prediction accuracy on conversion analysis.
- Integrated automated reporting with PowerPoint (python-pptx) for dynamic updates, scalable across experiments.

Local LLM-Powered Document Chatbot | [GitHub](#)

- Built a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) chatbot using Microsoft's Phi-1.5 LLM and sentence-transformers, fine-tuning deep learning embeddings for document retrieval.
- Enabled semantic search over unstructured PDFs using FAISS indexing and PyMuPDF-based chunking.
- Demonstrated applied use of transformer-based architectures and Git-based versioning for iteration tracking.

SKILLS

Programming: Python (Pandas, SciPy, Scikit-learn, Statsmodels, Seaborn, PyTorch, XGBoost), R, SQL, PySpark

Data Science: Classification, Regression, Time Series, Causal Inference, Forecasting, A/B Testing

Tools: Streamlit, Tableau, Microsoft Suite, Power BI, AWS, SageMaker, Airflow, Databricks, Postman

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Information Systems

California State University

Aug 2023 – May 2025

Long Beach, CA

Bachelor of Technology in Electronics and Communication Engineering

Institute of Aeronautical Engineering

Aug 2017– May 2021

Hyderabad, IN